

Short Biography

Rola Dagher, born in Lebanon, is an internationally recognized technology executive who has held key leadership roles at Dell Technologies and Cisco Canada, where she led major organizational transformations. Known for her influence and inclusive leadership, she has received numerous prestigious distinctions, including the Order of Canada and multiple honorary doctorates. Today, she inspires leaders to rethink their approach in the age of AI by championing authentic, human-centered, and impact-driven leadership.



Rola Dagher

1. A Transformational Leader in the Technology Sector

With more than 20 years of experience, Rola Dagher has led major global organizations, including serving as Global Channel Chief at Dell Technologies and as President and CEO of Cisco Canada.

2. Internationally Recognized Influence

Her impact on the global technology ecosystem has earned her numerous distinctions, including multiple recognitions from CRN and being ranked among the most influential women and business leaders in Canada and internationally.

3. A Strong Voice for Equity and Inclusive Leadership

As a co-founder of the BlackNorth Initiative, she actively advocates for diversity, representation, and the elevation of underrepresented voices within organizations.

4. An Exceptional Personal and Academic Journey

From her childhood in a country marked by war to reaching the highest levels of global leadership, her remarkable journey has earned her four honorary doctorates and prestigious distinctions, including the Order of Canada.

5. A Forward-Looking Vision of Leadership

Today, Rola Dagher inspires leaders to reinvent their approach in the age of AI by championing authentic, human-centered, and impact-driven leadership—guided by her philosophy: *“Learn it. Earn it. Return it.”*

Rola Dagher

1. A seasoned technology executive, Rola Dagher has held senior leadership roles at Dell Technologies and Cisco Canada, where she led large-scale transformations.
2. A globally recognized and influential leader, she has received numerous prestigious awards in Canada and internationally for her impact and leadership.
3. A committed advocate for equity and inclusion, she is a co-founder of the BlackNorth Initiative and serves on several boards and advisory councils.
4. An inspiring and exceptional journey—from childhood in a war-torn country to receiving the Order of Canada and four honorary doctorates.
5. A champion of modern leadership, she encourages leaders to innovate with authenticity, humanity, and impact.

Rola Dagher

Leadership is not a title, it's a daily choice to act with purpose, conviction, and courage. Rola Dagher lives by this belief. With over two decades of experience in the technology industry, she has led transformational change, built world-class teams, and championed inclusive leadership at every turn. Dagher returned to Dell Technologies in 2020–2023 as Global Channel Chief after a groundbreaking tenure as President and CEO of Cisco Canada. She previously held senior sales leadership roles at Dell and Bell Canada. Her influence on the global channel ecosystem earned her recognition as one of CRN's Global 50 Most Influential Channel Chiefs, Channel Influencer, and multiple accolades including CRN's Women of the Year, Power 100, and Top 100 Executives. A passionate advocate for equity and representation, Dagher has made it her mission to elevate diverse voices. She's been honored as one of Canada's Most Powerful Women: Top 100™, WXN's Top 25 Women of Influence™, WCT's Woman of the Year. She was also recognized by RBC as one of the Top 25 Canadian Immigrants of the year. Her extraordinary journey, from a childhood in a war-torn country to boardrooms at the helm of global enterprises, has earned her four Honorary Doctorates (LL.D.) from McMaster University, University of Waterloo, Toronto Metropolitan University, and Wilfrid Laurier University. In 2023, Dagher was appointed to the Order of Canada and received the prestigious King Charles III Medal and the Horatio Alger International Award. Beyond the boardroom, Dagher co-founded the BlackNorth Initiative and serves on the advisory boards of Catalyst and the 30% Club. She sits on the Board of Trustees for SickKids Hospital, is a Director of the Horatio Alger Association of Canada, and a council member of the University of Waterloo Dean's Advisory Council and Shift Canada. Today, Rola inspires leaders to rewire and reimagine their thinking for the AI era, to shift from legacy leadership to human-centered innovation. Her message is clear: the future belongs to those who lead with authenticity, embrace reinvention, and prioritize impact over ego. At

the heart of her leadership philosophy is a powerful mantra: “Learn it. Earn it. Return it.” Rola Dagher continues to live this mission, empowering the next generation to rise, lead, and make lasting impact.

Résumé

Rola Dagher, née au Liban, est une dirigeante d’envergure internationale du secteur technologique, ayant occupé des postes clés chez Dell Technologies et Cisco Canada, où elle a mené des transformations majeures. Reconnue pour son influence et son leadership inclusif, elle a reçu de nombreuses distinctions prestigieuses, dont l’Ordre du Canada et plusieurs doctorats honorifiques. Aujourd’hui, elle inspire les leaders à réinventer leur approche à l’ère de l’IA, en prônant un leadership authentique, humain et axé sur l’impact.

Rola Dagher

1. Une leader transformatrice du secteur technologique

Forte de plus de 20 ans d’expérience, Rola Dagher a dirigé des organisations mondiales majeures, notamment comme Global Channel Chief chez Dell Technologies et comme présidente et cheffe de la direction de Cisco Canada.

2. Une influence reconnue à l’échelle internationale

Son impact sur l’écosystème technologique mondial lui a valu de nombreuses distinctions, dont plusieurs reconnaissances de CRN et son classement parmi les femmes et dirigeantes les plus influentes au Canada et à l’international.

3. Une voix engagée pour l’équité et le leadership inclusif

Cofondatrice de l’initiative BlackNorth, elle milite activement pour la diversité, la représentation et l’élévation des voix sous-représentées au sein des organisations.

4. Un parcours personnel et académique exceptionnel

De son enfance dans un pays marqué par la guerre jusqu’aux plus hauts sommets du leadership mondial, son parcours lui a valu quatre doctorats honorifiques et des honneurs prestigieux, dont l’Ordre du Canada.

5. Une vision moderne du leadership tournée vers l’avenir

Aujourd’hui, Rola Dagher inspire les leaders à réinventer leur approche à l’ère de l’IA, en prônant un leadership authentique, humain et axé sur l’impact, guidé par sa philosophie : « *Learn it. Earn it. Return it.* »

Rola Dagher

1. **Dirigeante chevronnée du secteur technologique**, Rola Dagher a occupé des postes de premier plan chez Dell Technologies et Cisco Canada, où elle a mené des transformations d'envergure.
2. **Leader d'influence reconnue mondialement**, elle a reçu de nombreuses distinctions prestigieuses au Canada et à l'international pour son impact et son leadership.
3. **Figure engagée pour l'équité et l'inclusion**, elle est cofondatrice de la BlackNorth Initiative et siège à plusieurs conseils et conseils consultatifs.
4. **Parcours inspirant et exceptionnel**, de son enfance dans un pays en guerre à l'Ordre du Canada et à quatre doctorats honorifiques.
5. **Porteuse d'une vision moderne du leadership**, elle invite les leaders à innover avec authenticité, humanité et impact.